

Eat good. Live good. Build something.

Island Grill has always reached beyond the restaurant walls. Hack876 is a long day of building for young Jamaicans, and a good Jamaican lunch keeps the ideas coming.

Kingston, Jamaica • Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

80

STUDENTS

9

SCHOOL NETWORK

1

DAY



ONE DAY TO BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Real food, and a real skill set, for young Jamaicans.

Hack876 asks students to try something new and see it through, which is exactly how Island Grill was built.

ISLAND GRILL

“We create value for all stakeholders by delighting our customers, each and every time, with excellent food and service, with ease, grace and joy; making it possible for all to Eat Good and Live Good.”²

In 2024 Thalia Lyn announced the Lyn Family/Island Grill Scholarship in Technology for a deserving student at Immaculate Conception High School, her alma mater.³

By 2016 Island Grill's Soupaah Pot of Love had run over 180 projects and donated more than 10,000 cups of soup, including to schools across the country.⁴

In 2017 Island Grill launched its Supaah Food menu of locally grown foods, in line with the country's mandate to encourage Jamaicans to eat local and healthier.⁵

Island Grill grew by trying new things: jerk seasoning on grilled chicken, then callaloo rice and festival with chicken instead of the usual dinner roll.⁶

A Jamaican brand that feeds more than its customers.

1991

Founded by Thalia Lyn.

Island Grill begins its life as one of the few authentic Jamaican quick service restaurants.²

2016

Soupaah Pot of Love.

Over 180 projects and more than 10,000 cups of soup donated, with staff serving schools and communities in person.⁴

2017

Supaah Food.

A menu of locally grown foods with good nutritional value, to encourage Jamaicans to eat local and healthier.⁵

2024

A scholarship in technology.

The Lyn Family/Island Grill Scholarship in Technology is announced at Immaculate Conception High School.³

2026

Still growing.

Eighteen restaurants, with a plan to reach 30 by 2030.¹

Island Grill already feeds communities and backs young people in technology. One lunch at Hack876 puts both in the same room.



9 schools. One room.

Thalia Lyn is an Immaculate alumna, the first inductee of its Hall of Fame in 2013, and announced a technology scholarship there in 2024. Our judge Sheneska Williams is an Immaculate alumna too. Immaculate is in the Hack876 school network; its participation is not yet confirmed.³

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

Hillel Academy	Campion College
Jamaica College	Immaculate Conception High School
Wolmer's	Ardenne High School
American International School of Kingston	St. Andrew High School for Girls
St. George's College	

There are two natural homes for this inside Island Grill.

FOOD

Feed the room for one day

- ✓ One sponsored lunch, in kind, on the day
- ✓ Not a catering or canteen arrangement
- ✓ Plates from the regular menu, vegetarian included
- ✓ Island Grill team members serving, if they would like to

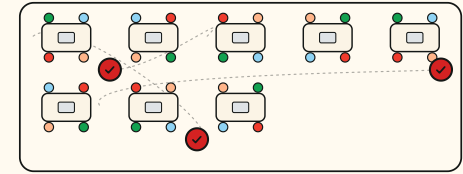
PEOPLE

Island Grill people in the room

- ✓ A short founder talk on starting small and trying new things
- ✓ Mentors for Business track teams
- ✓ A proposed award, presented on stage

Island Grill's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

PEOPLE IN THE ROOM.



01

Lunch team

Island Grill staff who serve the meal and keep the line moving.

02

Speaker

A short, honest talk on building a Jamaican brand by trying new things.

03

Mentors

Innovation and marketing staff who help Business track teams think like operators.

04

Award presenters

The Island Grill team presents its award on stage at the close.

05

Judging support

Island Grill can advise on award criteria; the judging panel decides.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

The lunch is the contribution: no promotions, coupons, sign-ups or marketing campaigns aimed at students beyond the meal itself.

No collection of student contact details or data by sponsors. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

Dietary needs come first. Hack876 collects allergies and dietary requirements in advance and shares only the meal counts Island Grill needs.

Become a Food & Student Experience Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

US\$1,000

FOOD & STUDENT EXPERIENCE PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

Lunch is the one moment every student shares. A one-day, in-kind Island Grill lunch is simple, concrete and close to how Island Grill already serves communities.

What it covers:

- ✓ Student meals
- ✓ Snacks
- ✓ Water and refreshments
- ✓ Serving supplies
- ✓ Light hospitality

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

Island Grill

Food & Student Experience Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Business, Culture, Wellbeing

Choose the level that fits.

Official Prize Partner

~US\$3,500

Hack 876 Winner	iPad per student (up to 4)	Approximately US\$1,800
Second Place	AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)	Approximately US\$1,000
Third Place	US\$150 gift card per student (up to 4)	US\$600

Special Awards Partner

US\$600

OUR SUGGESTION FOR ISLAND GRILL

Best Design, Boldest Idea, People's Choice: US\$600 for all 3, or US\$200 for one, presented by Island Grill.

Food & Student Experience Partner

US\$1,000

OUR SUGGESTION FOR ISLAND GRILL

Approximately J\$150,000 for meals and refreshments, in cash or in kind.

In-kind / People Partner

TIME AND EXPERTISE

Lunch for students, mentors, judges and volunteers, delivered to the venue, grilled chicken, fried fish and vegetarian meals with rice and peas or festival, island Grill team members to help serve, as they do on community projects.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

Island Grill Business Builder Award (proposed)

A suggestion only: an award for the build that would most help a small Jamaican business, with criteria agreed together and the final call left to the judging panel.

Costs are approximate. Final prize configuration may change with team structure, pricing and availability.

Every option at a glance.

FOOD & STUDENT EXPERIENCE PARTNER

US\$1,000

INAUGURAL HACK876

Lunch is the one moment every student shares. A one-day, in-kind Island Grill lunch is simple, concrete and close to how Island Grill already serves communities.

OFFICIAL PRIZE PARTNER
The primary competition prizes.

~US\$3,500

SPECIAL AWARDS PARTNER
All 3 special awards, or US\$200 for one.

US\$600

IN-KIND / PEOPLE PARTNER
Judges, mentors, speakers, volunteers and resources.

Time

ISLAND GRILL BUSINESS BUILDER AWARD (PROPOSED)
A custom award shaped together.

Proposed

The size of the commitment can change. The invitation to be part of the first one does not.

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Thalia Lyn, Founder and Deputy Chairman, Island Grill.**¹

If Island Grill is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ Is this a one-day lunch or a catering arrangement?
- ✓ How many plates, where and when?
- ✓ How much notice would our team get?
- ✓ How are allergies and dietary needs handled?
- ✓ Will Immaculate Conception take part?
- ✓ Could our people do more than serve lunch?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.

Learn from it.

**Earn the right to make
the second one bigger.**

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

A recurring Island Grill lunch at every Hack876.

A Supaah Food lunch built around local produce.

A Business track challenge built on a real Island Grill problem, if the team wants one.

A Hack876 pathway toward the Lyn Family/Island Grill Scholarship in Technology, only if the family wishes.



HACK876 x ISLAND GRILL

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Thalia and the Island Grill team.

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hack876.com

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SOURCES

1. Jamaica Gleaner, "Island Grill targets 30 stores by 2030 in stepped-up expansion (September 16, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/business/20260916/island-grill-targets-30-stores-2030-stepped-expansion
2. Island Grill, "Despite COVID-19, the NEW King Street Island Grill Will Open (About Island Grill, May 10, 2020)." www.islandgrillja.com/blog/post/despite-covid19-the-new-king-street-island-grill-will-open
3. Jamaica Observer, "Lyn announces technology scholarship at Immaculate High (March 24, 2024)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2024/03/24/lyn-announces-technology-scholarship-immaculate-high/
4. Jamaica Gleaner, "Island Grill serving up soup to those in need (June 19, 2016)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20160624/island-grill-serving-soup-those-need
5. Island Grill, "Press: Island Grill Launches Supaah Foods (July 26, 2017)." www.islandgrillja.com/press
6. Jamaica Observer, "A taste of perseverance: The Island Grill Story (August 21, 2024)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2024/08/21/taste-perseverance-island-grill-story/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Thalia Lyn, Founder and Deputy Chairman, Island Grill, with Tania Waldron-Gooden, Chief Executive Officer.